LESSON PACK · WEEK 7 · LESSON 2 · THE ENVIRONMENT

If we don't act…

Grammar · First conditional: If + present, will (+ unless)

Words · Environmental problems



BY THE END YOU CAN SAY

If we don't recycle, there will be more trash.

Unless we act now, it will be too late.

WARM-UP · ELEMENTARY IS STILL ALIVE

Let's talk first

1. Elementary: I'll help you with something. What will you do to help your city? Say one sentence.

   Elementary: Я тебе помогу. Что ты сделаешь, чтобы помочь своему городу? Скажи одно предложение.

2. What will happen if people don't stop using plastic? Say one sentence.

   Что произойдёт, если люди не перестанут использовать пластик? Скажи одно предложение.

DID YOU KNOW?

Every year about 8 million tons of plastic go into the oceans.

Каждый год в океаны попадает около 8 миллионов тонн пластика.

CORE WORDS 1 / 2

Today's 20 words

P
pollution
загрязнение

S
smog
смог

W
waste
отходы

E
exhaust fumes
выхлопные газы


plastic
пластик

O
oil spill
разлив нефти

L
litter
мусор (на улице)

D
deforestation
вырубка лесов

L
landfill
свалка

D
drought
засуха

CORE WORDS 2 / 2

Today's 20 words

W **wildfire**
лесной пожар

D **damage**
ущерб, повредить

E **extinction**
вымирание

D **destroy**
разрушать

O **overfishing**
перелов рыбы

T **threaten**
угрожать

T **toxic**
токсичный

P **pollute**
загрязнять

H **harmful**
вредный

E **emission**
выброс

EXTRA WORDS 1 / 2 · ONLY IF YOU WANT MORE

20 extra words, easy to use

C
contamination
заражение, загрязнение

A
acid rain
кислотный дождь

S
sewage
сточные воды

S
sea level
уровень моря

C
chemical
химикат

H
heat wave
волна жары

P
pesticide
пестицид

F
famine
голод

F
fertilizer
удобрение

T
toxin
токсин

EXTRA WORDS 2 / 2 · ONLY IF YOU WANT MORE

20 extra words, easy to use

S
scarcity
дефицит

O
overpopulation
перенаселение

U
urbanization
урбанизация

N
noise pollution
шумовое загрязнение

H
hazardous
опасный

R
radioactive
радиоактивный

N
nuclear
ядерный

C
crisis
кризис

C
catastrophe
катастрофа

T
threat
угроза

HOW IT WORKS · 1

First conditional: If + present, will

If we don't recycle, there will be more trash. ✓

Если мы не будем перерабатывать, мусора станет больше.

If it rains, we won't go to the park. ✓

Если пойдёт дождь, мы не пойдём в парк.

If you study, you'll pass the test. ✓

Если ты будешь учиться, ты сдашь тест.

If + present simple, will + base verb: a real future possibility

If + present simple, will + глагол — реальная возможность в будущем

No will in the if-part: If it will rain ✗

После if — без will

Compare: zero = always true · first = a possible future result

Нулевой — всегда, первый — возможный результат

HOW IT WORKS · 2

unless = if not

Unless we act now, it will be too late. ✓

Если мы не начнём действовать сейчас, будет слишком поздно.

We'll lose the forest unless we protect it. ✓

Мы потеряем лес, если не будем его защищать.

Unless you hurry, you'll miss the bus. ✓

Если ты не поторопишься, ты опоздаешь на автобус.

unless = if ... not: unless we act = if we don't act

unless = if ... not

Positive verb after unless: unless we act ✓ · unless we don't act ✗

После unless глагол без отрицания

Same rule: present after unless, will in the result

После unless — present simple, в результате — will

What will happen if we don't recycle?

If we don't recycle, there will be more trash.

Что будет, если мы не будем перерабатывать? Мусора станет больше.

What will happen if the ocean gets hotter?

If the ocean gets hotter, many fish will die.

Что будет, если океан станет теплее? Многие рыбы погибнут.

What will happen unless we act?

Unless we act, many species will disappear.

Что будет, если мы не начнём действовать? Многие виды исчезнут.

Ask: What will happen if...?

Спрашиваем: What will happen if...?

Answer: If + present, will + verb

Отвечаем по схеме

Use today's words: pollution, waste, extinction, damage, threaten

HOW IT WORKS · 4

Chain of consequences

If we don't recycle,	there will be more trash.
If there is more trash,	the oceans will get dirtier.
If animals eat plastic,	they will get sick.
If animals die,	people will lose food.

Each result becomes the next if: a chain game

Результат становится следующим if

Keep going: If people lose food, ...

Продолжайте цепочку

WATCH OUT

Four mistakes to avoid

If it will rain, we won't go. ✗ → **If it rains, we won't go.** ✓

после if — present simple

Unless we don't act, it will be too late. ✗ → **Unless we act, it will be too late.** ✓

unless = if not

If you study, you pass the test. ✗ → **If you study, you'll pass the test.** ✓

результат — will

If we don't recycle, there are more trash. ✗ → **If we don't recycle, there will be more trash.** ✓

будущий результат — will

EXAMPLE SENTENCES

Look and say

If we don't recycle, there will be more trash.
Если мы не будем перерабатывать, мусора станет больше.

Unless we act now, it will be too late.
Если мы не начнём действовать сейчас, будет слишком поздно.

If the oil spills into the sea, many animals will die.
Если нефть разольётся в море, погибнет много животных.

If we cut down more trees, the drought will get worse.
Если мы вырубим больше деревьев, засуха усилится.

The air won't be clean unless we reduce emissions.
Воздух не будет чистым, если мы не сократим выбросы.

If you throw away plastic, it will stay in the landfill for hundreds of years.
Если выбросить пластик, он будет лежать на свалке сотни лет.

If it doesn't rain, the wildfire will spread.
Если не будет дождя, пожар распространится.

Unless we protect the rainforest, many species will disappear.
Если мы не защитим тропический лес, многие виды исчезнут.

WORDS THAT GO TOGETHER

Collocations and phrasal verbs

5 COLLOCATIONS

do damage
наносить ущерб

make a difference
изменить ситуацию

take action
принять меры

waste energy
тратить энергию впустую

reduce waste
сокращать отходы

2 PHRASAL VERBS

throw away
выбросить

wipe out
уничтожить

Make one sentence with each of them. They are part of today's homework.

SPEAKING

Consequence chain

1. Sit in a circle. Student 1 starts: If we don't recycle, there will be more trash.
2. Student 2 continues with the result: If there is more trash, the oceans will get dirty.
3. Keep going. Nobody can repeat an idea. When the chain stops, start a new one.
4. Then change one if to unless: Unless we recycle, …

EXAMPLE

A. If we don't recycle, there will be more trash.

B. If there is more trash, animals will get sick.

C. If animals get sick, people will lose food.

D. Unless we act, it will be too late!

if + present simple, will + base verb. No will after if or unless. unless = if not.

PLAY TO PRACTICE

Games with a working link

Baamboozle: First Conditional + Future Time Clauses

https://www.baamboozle.com/game/157557

Put the verb in the right form after if, unless, when, until and as soon as (We won't have dinner until Frank gets here). Game code 157557.

On the laptop: click the link, press **Play**, choose 2 to 4 teams. All pages were opened and checked on 31 Oct 2026.

LISTENING

Watch and listen

VOA Let's Learn English, Level 1, Lesson 51: A Good Habit

https://learningenglish.voanews.com/a/lets-learn-english-lesson-51-a-good-habit/3773577.html

Video lesson with text and exercises.

VOA Let's Learn English, Level 2, Lesson 21: Trash to Treasure, Part 1

https://learningenglish.voanews.com/a/lets-learn-english-level-2-lesson-21/4273059.html

Video lesson with text and exercises. Harder (Level 2): listen for the main idea.

Pick the one you like. First for the main idea, then again with the text.

LAST 5 MINUTES

Say it! Exit check

1. **Say:** if / we / not recycle / there / be / more trash
2. **Say:** unless / we / act / it / be / too late
3. **Say:** if / it / rain / we / not go
4. **Correct it:** If it will rain, we won't go.
5. **Elementary:** What will you do to help your city?

Ask aloud, one student at a time. The answers are on the last page.

LAST 10 MINUTES

Speak! Recap with questions

1. What will happen if people keep using plastic?
2. What will happen if we cut down all the forests?
3. What will you do if it rains this weekend?
4. What will happen to the planet unless we reduce emissions?
5. If you find litter in the park, what will you do?
6. What will happen if you don't recycle?
7. If you have a lot of free time, what will you do for nature?
8. What will the world be like unless we act?

Ask in pairs, then ask the whole class. Perfect sentences, please: stop and repeat if there is a mistake.

TEACHER · ANSWERS

Answer key · exercises

1 · First conditional: fill in

1. don't recycle, will be · 2. rains, won't go · 3. study, will pass ·
4. gets, will die · 5. cut down, will get · 6. doesn't rain, will spread

2 · if or unless?

1. Unless · 2. if · 3. Unless · 4. unless · 5. if · 6. If

3 · Rewrite with unless

1. Unless we act now, it will be too late. ·
2. Unless you hurry, you'll miss the bus. ·
3. Unless we protect the forest, we'll lose it. ·
4. Unless you study, you won't pass. ·
5. Unless we reduce waste, the landfill will be full.

4 · Find and correct the mistake

1. If it rains, we won't go. · 2. Unless we act, it will be too late. ·
3. If you study, you'll pass the test. ·
4. If we don't recycle, there will be more trash. · 5. I will go if it is sunny.

5 · Read and write T (true) or F (false)

1. T · 2. F · 3. F · 4. T · 5. T

6 · About you

Personal answers. Check if + present simple, will + base verb.

TEACHER · ANSWERS

Answer key · exit check and homework

EXIT CHECK

1. Say: if / we / not recycle / there / be / more trash → If we don't recycle, there will be more trash.
2. Say: unless / we / act / it / be / too late → Unless we act, it will be too late.
3. Say: if / it / rain / we / not go → If it rains, we won't go.
4. Correct it: If it will rain, we won't go. → If it rains, we won't go.
5. Elementary: What will you do to help your city? → Personal answers.

RUSSIAN → ENGLISH

1. Если мы не будем перерабатывать, мусора станет больше. → If we don't recycle, there will be more trash.
2. Если мы не начнём действовать сейчас, будет слишком поздно. → Unless we act now, it will be too late.
3. Если нефть разольётся в море, погибнет много животных. → If the oil spills into the sea, many animals will die.
4. Если мы вырубим больше деревьев, засуха усилится. → If we cut down more trees, the drought will get worse.
5. Воздух не будет чистым, если мы не сократим выбросы. → The air won't be clean unless we reduce emissions.
6. Если выбросить пластик, он будет лежать на свалке сотни лет. → If you throw away plastic, it will stay in the landfill for hundreds of years.
7. Если не будет дождя, пожар распространится. → If it doesn't rain, the wildfire will spread.
8. Если мы не защитим тропический лес, многие виды исчезнут. → Unless we protect the rainforest, many species will disappear.
9. Если пойдёт дождь, мы не пойдём в парк. → If it rains, we won't go to the park.
10. Если ты не поторопишься, ты опоздаешь на автобус. → Unless you hurry, you'll miss the bus.